

Assignment 1

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Q1)

1. Research papers, reports, and print-outs.
2. Hand-drawn maps of an area of Sheffield.
3. Completed questionnaires.
4. Data collection workshop materials.
5. Interview transcripts.
6. Old-looking memory sticks.
7. Project files on a secure network drive.
8. Teaching-related files.
9. Research data server files.
10. Qualitative data such as interview recordings and transcripts.
11. Visual data like photographs, hand-drawn maps, and diagrams.
12. Questionnaire data in Excel and SPSS files.

Q2)

The scientist mentioned that they have a lot of different files and folders, but they are unsure about the exact amount of data in gigabytes. They mentioned that the data they currently work on, including 30 interview recordings, 30 transcripts, an Nvivo file, and related Excel spreadsheets, could easily fit on a memory stick, but it's a significant amount of data in terms of the number of files.

Q3)

The scientist stated that they store and back up their data using various methods, including:

- University servers: They back up their data on the university servers, which include their personal university drive and the university cloud storage.
- Research data server: The computer service has set up a specific research data server for the scientist's research group, and they are starting to use it for storage and backup.
- Filing cabinet and locked drawer: They also mentioned having print-outs and other materials stored in a filing cabinet or a locked drawer in their desk.

Q4)

The scientist acknowledged that legally the university owns the data. However, they personally care about and use the data for their work.

Q5)

The scientist mentioned that there has been a change in the practice of data sharing. They have recently shared data from a survey about bibliometrics on the university data repository, as well as data related to publications. They expressed their support for data sharing but also mentioned that they have only recently begun to get into the habit of sharing data. They also expressed some doubts about the usefulness of their data to other researchers, as it is often specific to their projects. They haven't reused data created by other researchers themselves, although they find the idea appealing.

Further subtask)

Based on the interview, there are several potential problems in Andrew's behavior, attitudes, and expectations:

Untidy office: Andrew admits that his office is untidy, with papers, books, and various materials scattered around. This lack of organization can lead to difficulties in finding and accessing important documents and data.

Lack of knowledge about data quantity: Andrew mentions that he has no idea about the amount of data he has in terms of gigabytes. This lack of awareness about the size of his data can make it challenging to effectively manage and store the data.

Inadequate data storage and backup: While Andrew mentions using various methods for data storage and backup, such as university servers, personal university drive, and the research data server, he also notes that some of these storage options are full or that he is just starting to use them. This suggests a potential lack of proper and consistent data backup practices, which can result in data loss or compromise.

Ownership of data: Andrew acknowledges that legally the university owns the data, but he personally cares about and uses it. This ambiguity in ownership can lead to potential conflicts or misunderstandings regarding data rights and usage.

Limited data sharing: Although Andrew expresses support for data sharing, he admits that in the past, there hasn't been much data sharing. While he mentions recent instances of sharing data on the university data repository and data related to publications, he also doubts the usefulness of his data to other researchers. This indicates a potential hesitation or reluctance to share data, which can hinder collaboration and hinder the progress of research.

Lack of data reuse: Andrew mentions that he hasn't reused data created by other researchers, despite finding the idea appealing. This suggests a missed opportunity for leveraging existing data and potentially generating new insights by building upon previous research.

Complexity in data organization: Andrew mentions that organizing his data is sometimes more complicated than simply categorizing it by project. Reusing material across multiple projects can lead to challenges in maintaining consistency, tracking versions, and retrieving specific data when needed.